Breaking the Chains of Generational Slavery

18 daughters. 36 families. A new beginning of hope.
Sheikhupura District, Pakistan | January–December 2024



Original documentary photograph, source report page 23.

18 marriages supported | 36 families reached | 2,000+ reported attendees

01 The plea that began everything

In January 2024, a pastoral visit to a congregation in Sheikhupura District brought the Church of Pentecost Pakistan into contact with families working at a local brick kiln. Sixteen women, most of them widows, approached church leaders with a deeply personal concern: their daughters' futures.

The women described a cycle of debt that had shaped their families' lives for years. The report says some households were already in a second generation of debt bondage, while the demanding work of brickmaking left little income for essentials. It records that the women described earnings of approximately US$10 a day, with nearly half deducted toward debts.

For these mothers, the fear was not only financial hardship. They worried that their daughters would be forced to begin adult life carrying the same burdens, particularly if marriage arrangements required further borrowing.



Families and workers at a brick kiln in Sheikhupura District. — Source PDF, p. 2



A family photographed near brick-kiln housing. — Source PDF, p. 3

02 One mother’s request; a decision for sixteen

One woman made an extraordinary proposal to Rev. Dr. Jamil Nasir: write down the names of the sixteen daughters and draw one by lottery. The selected young woman would receive help with her marriage; the other mothers would be grateful that at least one family had found an opportunity.

After prayer and discussion, the church’s leadership decided not to select just one daughter. It committed to assisting all sixteen. When two additional families later approached the church, the initiative grew to eighteen marriages.

The decision brought together a substantial task: addressing family debts, consulting with the brick kiln owner, preparing ceremonies, arranging hospitality, and providing household essentials. The source report describes nearly eleven months of planning and prayer.



A bride and guests approaching the wedding gathering. — Source PDF, p. 6



Wedding procession and attendees at the venue. — Source PDF, p. 7

03 December 6, 2024: a brick kiln transformed

The wedding celebration was held on December 6, 2024, at the brick kiln itself. According to the report, the owner agreed to make the premises available and suspend brick production for the occasion.

What had been a workplace associated with hardship became a gathering place of celebration. Eighteen couples participated, accompanied by relatives, church leaders, and community members. The report records attendance of more than 2,000 people.

Church workers organized seating, food, hospitality, and ceremonial arrangements. The photographs document the large outdoor congregation, the couples on stage, and the many practical preparations behind the celebration.



Household furniture arranged for the newly married couples. — Source PDF, p. 10



The community gathering at the brick-kiln venue. — Source PDF, p. 11



A sweeping view from the stage across the community wedding celebration. — Additional original photograph supplied by COP Pakistan



A bride and groom stand beside a multi-tiered wedding cake with attendees gathered behind. — Additional original photograph supplied by COP Pakistan



A bride and groom participate in a wedding ceremony with a minister. — Additional original photograph supplied by COP Pakistan



An elevated view of the collective ceremony with couples assembled on stage. — Additional original photograph supplied by COP Pakistan



An aerial view of seating and preparations at the outdoor wedding venue. — Additional original photograph supplied by COP Pakistan



A line of couples participating in the wedding celebrations. — Additional original photograph supplied by COP Pakistan

04 Beyond the wedding day: equipping new households

The church’s assistance extended beyond the ceremonies. The source report states that all eighteen brides received household furnishings and essential items, including beds, sofas, tables, cabinets, and crockery.

These contributions were intended to help the newly married couples establish their homes without immediately taking on further wedding-related debts. Original photographs also show furniture arranged for distribution and transportation.

The report describes thirty-six families connected with the eighteen marriages as beneficiaries of the wider initiative and says the church worked to address debts and provide relief from bondage. It does not provide audited debt totals or independently documented long-term outcomes, so this article presents those results as the church’s account.



A newly married couple pictured near household furnishings. — Source PDF, p. 21



Furniture and household items being transported. — Source PDF, p. 22



A couple and family members pictured beside household furniture at the event. — Additional original photograph supplied by COP Pakistan



A newly married couple stands among household furnishings supplied for new homes. — Additional original photograph supplied by COP Pakistan



A vehicle carrying furniture and household goods prepared for transportation. — Additional original photograph supplied by COP Pakistan



Rows of sofas, beds, and cabinets assembled for the newly married households. — Additional original photograph supplied by COP Pakistan

05 A ministry of compassion and a continuing invitation

For the Church of Pentecost Pakistan, this initiative reflects a belief that Christian witness includes both proclamation and practical service. The report describes continuing relationships with participating families through fellowship, encouragement, and spiritual support.

The experience highlights the vulnerability of families who work under heavy debt obligations, and the importance of protecting dignity while offering meaningful assistance. It also shows what coordinated pastoral care and community generosity can accomplish.

Churches, humanitarian organizations, and mission partners who would like to learn about COP Pakistan’s community work are invited to contact the ministry to discuss responsible, transparent opportunities for collaboration.



Couples standing on stage with church banners. — Source PDF, p. 29



The wedding gathering at the main stage. — Source PDF, p. 30

Partner in compassionate ministry

For questions about the initiative or possible mission partnerships, contact The Church of Pentecost Pakistan at **info@coppak.org** or visit **coppak.org**.

Source and verification note: Adapted from the 30-page Church of Pentecost Pakistan report provided for this project. All photographs originate in that report. The reported figures and debt-relief outcomes have not been independently verified.